One skill to practise teacher and cover plan

GROW Spring 1 Week 2 Monday 11 January 2027 P6 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Develop a skill and record it in my arts log.

Today: I can choose one technique, keep a first try and practise it.

Success criteria

I can choose one technique to practise.

I can keep a real before test and set one goal.

I can record what I tried and what I noticed.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For five pupils: five books or arts logs, five pencils and fifteen small test spaces or sheets for before, practice and after records. Reuse books to avoid extra sheets.

Optional visual route: six drawing tools including the adult model. If using paint, use six brushes, five mats, three stable water pots, a small amount of familiar paint and cloths. Dry marks need no paint.

Quiet or silent route: fingertips or a small comfortable seated action. No instruments or recording device are required.

Adult model: a four-mark line or a four-action pattern, plus a visibly labelled original before and after demonstration. Keep the adult example separate from pupil evidence.

Retain each pupil's chosen technique, baseline and cue for the second period. An adult can make a precise dated observation note when writing materials are unavailable.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0 to 15 seconds: Show a labelled adult first test with uneven gaps. Say: This is my real starting point for the model. Your before test stays yours.

15 to 30 seconds: Make one small mark, look at its gap, then place a matching mark. Say: I keep one shape and practise its gaps.

30 to 45 seconds: Make a four-action model on one slow count. Say: I keep this cue. I do not make it louder or faster.

45 to 60 seconds: Point to the first test and goal. Say: I will practise, then compare the same four-part test. I cannot promise it will improve today.

Arrival and starter

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Choose four marks or four quiet or silent actions. Keep this choice for both lessons. You may share privately.

What to say: Today you will choose one small technique to practise across both lessons. You could place four similar marks with even gaps, or make four quiet taps or silent finger actions at a steady pace. Pick a comfortable version. You may direct me and share privately. Before the first test, agree a neutral cue such as a slow count, or no cue. Keep the same cue and support for both tests.

What good looks like: The pupil chooses or confirms one form and technique. Staff note the choice before any teaching of the method. The quiet option and stop signal are clear.

Materials free fallback: Use four small silent finger actions or let the pupil direct the adult's actions. If movement is not comfortable, the pupil may direct an original four-part spoken sequence.

Check and response: There is no best form. The important choice is one manageable technique that can be used in both periods.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Make your first test before the adult teaches the skill. Use four marks or four actions. Keep a note of this first try.

What to say: This is your before test. Make four marks or four actions in your chosen way. I will not show a method yet. We will keep what really happens. If I help with materials, I will note that help. It is fine if this first try already works well. Use the cue agreed before this test, or no cue if that was the choice. I will not coach the target feature yet.

What good looks like: A real four-part baseline is retained before modelling. For marks, keep the actual row and describe its gaps. For actions, record the ordered pattern and whether the three intervals seemed steady or varied. Do not judge a pupil's feeling.

Materials free fallback: Adult witnesses the pupil's four silent actions or follows the pupil's four directions. Keep a dated note of the sequence, cue and actual support when a recording surface is available.

Check and response: The first test is evidence of a starting point, not a failure. Do not replace it with a class model or claim exact timing without measuring it.

Modelling and cover guidance

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I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Watch the adult choose one small goal. See how a guide or slow count can help. The teacher model is not your before test.

What to say: My goal is even gaps. I keep the same simple mark. I look at a gap, leave a similar gap, then make the next mark. I stop after four. For a steady action pattern I use a slow count, one, two, three, four, and make one small action on each count. I keep the same cue for practice and later tests. These are adult models.

What good looks like: The adult shows a simple repeatable method and one target: roughly even spaces for marks or a steady interval for actions. The pupil identifies the target and does not need to copy the adult's design.

Materials free fallback: Model the four-part method through quiet speech or comfortable silent gestures. A pupil can direct the adult. Use the same cue agreed for the pupil's chosen technique.

Check and response: Check: Is the target A add as many marks as possible, B control the gaps or pace, or C make a perfect picture? B. If unclear, show two short rows or patterns and name only the chosen feature.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Let each pupil choose a four-part mark or quiet or silent action technique. Before modelling, retain a real first test. Model only the chosen feature, then use two short practice rounds with a pause. Keep the baseline, goal, cue and log for lesson two. Use the seven-stage timing and final two Review minutes for tidy-up. No internet, instrument or specialist demonstration is needed.

Guided practice and making

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Practise the method with an adult or partner. Change one thing at a time. Choose your own goal for the next try.

What to say: Let us use one simple cue. Keep the same mark or action. Try four parts, pause and notice the gaps or pace. Which one thing will you practise? Hinge: our target is even gaps. Should we A change the colour and size at once, B keep the mark and practise its gaps, or C add more marks so the row looks busy? Tell me why.

What good looks like: The pupil selects B and identifies the feature to practise. An adult may model one step, then return the next action to the pupil. Each pupil has their own goal rather than a copied group answer.

Materials free fallback: Use four silent actions with one slow cue. The pupil may direct the adult. Point to or say A, B or C. No sound or art materials are needed.

Check and response: If the pupil chooses A or C, show only the target feature and ask a parallel question: For a steady four-action pattern, should we keep the cue the same or change the speed each time? Keep it the same. Continue when the pupil identifies one focused target.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: Use your chosen technique. Keep the same four-part test. Practise in two short rounds, with a pause between. Keep your first test. Note your cue and one goal.

What to say: Use your before record to choose one target. Practise a short round, pause, notice, then practise again. You may use more space for practice, but keep the four-part test for comparison. Record the cue, size or pace guide and any adult help. You will use the same technique in the next lesson. A pause is part of practice.

What good looks like: The pupil practises the chosen technique, retains the baseline and records a specific target and cue. Staff can identify the chosen feature and what help was used. A practice round is labelled as practice, not an invented final result.

Materials free fallback: Use a silent four-action sequence or pupil-directed adult sequence. Adult retains a precise dated witness note of the before test, chosen cue, practice and pupil view. A device is not needed.

Check and response: Examples of a clear goal: I will leave similar gaps between four marks. I will keep a steady pace for four small actions. Accept a comfortable adapted version.

Optional progression evidence

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Optional next level stretch

What to say: If you want the extra task, Set one skill goal. Keep your first test. Try a cue and ask for one useful comment. Say why you will keep or change the cue for practice. Plan a fair next test.

What good looks like: The pupil links a specific skill target to a chosen practice cue and a reasoned response to feedback. The record sets up a fair later comparison.

Materials free fallback: Adult records the same prompts orally, including the exact four-action sequence, cue, support and pupil's own reason.

Retain: Keep your goal, first test, practice note, feedback and reason. Note the cue for the next test.

This task is extra. Your Explore work is complete without it. Keep the record in case your next level changes.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Show your first test and one practice try. Say what you notice. It may be the same. Keep your work and cue for next time.

What to say: Compare the real records. What stayed the same? What changed? You can say that you need more practice. A partner can notice one feature without ranking the work. In the final two minutes, put tools away, keep paintings flat and store the baseline and cue together.

What good looks like: The pupil makes a specific observation about gaps or pace and retains their own starting point. No improvement is assumed. Private sharing is enough. The next-period cue is clear.

Materials free fallback: An adult repeats the witnessed sequence from the note and asks the pupil to confirm it. Keep staff observations distinct from the pupil's words.

Check and response: Useful: The gap after mark two is smaller. The first three actions were steady and the last came sooner. Vague praise alone is not the comparison.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Arts log: My technique is ___. My first try showed ___. My goal is ___. Next time I will use the same ___.

What to say: Add today's actual date. Record your chosen technique, what the first test showed, the goal and cue you will keep. You may speak, sign or direct a scribe. I will read your words back. Next lesson we will practise again and keep an honest after test.

What good looks like: A dated log links the actual baseline to a small skill goal and a consistent cue for lesson two. Support is recorded and the pupil confirms scribed words.

Materials free fallback: Pupil gives an oral or gestured log. Adult records the exact confirmed choice and the observed four-part test at the next available opportunity.

Check and response: Do not prefill the later result. The after test has not happened yet.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the task and skill words aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

Practice always makes the second version better. - Record what actually happened. It may improve, stay similar or need more practice. A clear observation is useful evidence.

More marks or faster taps show more skill. - The chosen target is control. Keep four marks or actions in the test and focus on the gaps or pace.

A fair before and after comparison can use completely different tasks. - Use the same chosen technique and four-part test. Keep similar conditions and note help. If access requires a new form, keep the old record and make a fresh baseline for that form.

A polished adult example can replace a pupil's first try. - Keep the pupil's real baseline, attempt and words. Label all adult samples as teacher models.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.